7.1 Introduction

We know in an organisation many people work together in order to achieve a common goal. At the same time we want to understand that there will be a person who should frame these organisational goals and direct all the people's effort towards common goal. So the word direct (or) direction is an act of framing objectives and communicating that to the people (employees) and with motivating them to achieve those objectives with least effort and time.

7.2 Meaning

The behaviour of making other employees to work for a common organisational goal is called as Leadership. It is the art of influencing others to direct their will, abilities and efforts to the achievement of Organisational goals. Leadership is a quality of behaviour of the individuals whereby they guide people (or) their activities in organised effort. It is a capacity of an individual to influence the thought and actions of others in some useful direction.

7.3 Definition

Leadership may be defined in terms of totality of functions performed by executives as individuals and as a group.

According to Davis: "Leadership is the ability to persuade others to seek defined objectives enthusiastically. It is the human factor which binds a group to gather and motivates it towards goals".

According to Koontz and Donnell, "Leadership is the ability of a manager to induce subordinates to work with confidence and zeal".



Figure 7.1 Leadership is followership.

7.4 Characteristics of Leadership

1. Leadership is basically a personal quality. This Quality motivates the individuals to be with leaders.
2. Leader, by exercising his leadership, tries to influence the behaviour of individuals around him to fulfil certain pre-determined objectives.
3. Leader tries to influence the individual to behave in a particular way.
4. There is a relationship between leader and individuals (followers) which arises out of functioning for a common goal.
5. Leadership is a continuous process of influencing behaviour.

DO YOU KNOW?

Indra Nooyi, is the Chairman of PepsiCo, Inc. The company is an American multinational food, snack, and beverage corporation headquartered in Harrison, New York. She is an Indian born American lady and considered to be world's most 100 powerful women by Forbes magazine.

Indira Priyadarshini Gandhi, was an Indian politician, stateswoman and a central figure of the Indian National Congress. She was the first and, to date, the only female Prime Minister of India. Indira Gandhi was the daughter of Jawaharlal Nehru, the first prime minister of India.

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